

Using Stellarium

Student worksheet

Use Stellarium to explore how the sky changes with location and time. These controls refer to the desktop application.

Name _____ Date _____

Set up your view

1. Open Stellarium and explore its controls for a few minutes.
2. Open Location with F6. Choose your observing location, or use Charlotte for the original lesson example.
3. Open Time with F5 and choose a date and time. Record these settings below.
4. Turn off the atmosphere to make stars visible during simulated daylight. Open View with F4 to explore display options.

Starting location _____ Date and time _____

Compare three locations

Choose locations near the North Pole, South Pole, and equator. Keep the same date for each comparison. Increase the simulation speed and watch the stars move. Record the direction you face so your description is clear.

Location and latitude	Viewing direction	Star paths and apparent motion
Near North Pole		
Near South Pole		
Near equator		

Explain your observations

How do the star paths differ between locations? What causes the sky's apparent daily motion?

[Stellarium user guide](#)